

Answer key & lesson script

Core questions 1–6. Questions 7–8 and the literary tools section are extensions.

90-minute lesson: recall 5; poet background 8; rereading 7; worksheet 20; discussion 20; visual breaks and idiom 5; optional extension 20; exit ticket 5.

Poet background: Robert Frost (1874–1963) was an American poet. Many of his poems use New England landscapes and everyday speech to explore difficult human experiences. He lived in England from 1912 to 1915, where he became friends with the poet Edward Thomas.

Reading stance: distinguish Frost from the speaker. Compare lines 9–12 with the imagined later story in lines 16–20. Avoid presenting “choose the unpopular path” as the only meaning. The sigh permits more than one supported interpretation.

1. He is in a yellow wood where two roads separate. He must choose one road because he cannot travel both at once.
2. The road bends into the undergrowth, so he cannot see beyond the bend (lines 4–5).
3. “Had worn them really about the same” (line 10), or “both that morning equally lay” (line 11).
4. He knows that “way leads on to way” (line 14): one journey or choice leads to others, making a return uncertain.
5. They can represent different choices in life. The traveler must choose without knowing the full result, just as people do when making important decisions.
6. It may suggest regret: he was “sorry” he could not travel both roads. It may also suggest reflection or satisfaction, linked to “all the difference.” The poem does not settle its meaning.

Thinking, context & writing

7. Bridging sample: Thomas's habit of imagining a better route helps explain the speaker's focus on the road he did not take. The wish to keep it "for another day" suggests that choosing does not end his thoughts about the other possibility.

8. Sample response: The speaker may feel satisfied, but the poem leaves room for doubt. He imagines saying that his choice made "all the difference," which could sound positive. However, he also says that he was "sorry" he could not travel both roads. His future "sigh" may express regret or simply reflection. These details suggest mixed feelings rather than a clearly happy or unhappy ending.

Assessment: accept satisfaction, regret, mixed feelings or uncertainty when two relevant details are explained. "All the difference" does not itself state whether the result was good or bad.

LOTS: finding, identifying and recalling explicit information. **HOTS:** inferring, comparing, explaining or evaluating with evidence. The question word alone does not determine the thinking level.

Literary tools: poem = literary text; poet = writer; speaker = voice in the poem; line = one row; stanza = group of lines; metaphor = one thing standing for another; theme = a central idea explored in the text.

Bridging: background detail + poem detail + an explained connection. The Thomas background opens a useful reading; it does not prove that the speaker is Thomas or settle every ambiguity.

Visual riddle: At sixes and sevens = confused or disorganized. The cats are a playful number clue, not the idiom's origin. The silent clip plays only when selected; moving slides stops playback.

Sources

Poem: Academy of American Poets

Biography: Academy of American Poets

Background: David Orr, Academy of American Poets

Idiom: Cambridge Dictionary